

How to Prepare for System Design Interviews

Having helped thousands of candidates pass their FAANG interviews, we've learned exactly what works.

Build a Foundation

- 1. Understand what a system design interview is:** Maybe you've never done a system design interview before, you're not alone! Start by reading our [intro to system design](#) or [watching a video of a mock system design interview](#).
- 2. Choose a delivery framework:** System design interviews move fast. It's important that you have a clear roadmap to help you think linearly and avoid scope creep. We strongly recommend our [Delivery Framework](#). This is the framework you'll follow to design your system come interview day.
- 3. Start with the basics:** If you're new to system design in particular, you'll want to start by learning the basics and mapping out the scope of knowledge required. Start by reading about the [Core Concepts](#), [Key Technologies](#), and [Common Patterns](#) used in system design interviews. These write-ups are high-level, but they help you build the mental model necessary to build upon.

Practice Practice Practice

Once you have the foundation in place, it's time to practice. Passively consuming content is good, but you'll retain 10x more information by actually doing.

- 1. Choose a question:** Select a question from the list of common questions below.
- 2. Read the requirements:** Understand the requirements of the system you'll need to design.
- 3. Try to answer on your own:** Either practice with our [Guided Practices](#) (below) or on a virtual whiteboard like [Excalidraw](#).
- 4. Read the answer key:** Only after you have tried to answer the question, read the answer key to see how your answer compares.
- 5. Put your knowledge to the test:** Once you've done a few questions and are feeling comfortable, run a peer mock with someone who works at your target company — telling your design out loud under time pressure is a different skill than reading about it.

Interview Question

Write-Up

[Bitly](#)



Interview Question	Write-Up
Dropbox	
Local Delivery Service	
News Aggregator	
Ticketmaster	
FB News Feed	
Tinder	
LeetCode	
WhatsApp	
Yelp	
Strava	
Rate Limiter	
Online Auction	

Interview Question	Write-Up
FB Live Comments	
FB Post Search	
Price Tracking Service	
Instagram	
YouTube Top K	
Uber	
Robinhood	
Google Docs	
Distributed Cache	
YouTube	
Job Scheduler	
Web Crawler	

Interview Question	Write-Up
Ad Click Aggregator	
Payment System	
Metrics Monitoring	
ChatGPT	

More Practice

Full Guided Practice on additional interview questions. These problems don't include a written guide but have the same step-by-step practice and AI feedback and are sourced from real interview questions reported by the community.

Interview Question
Donations Website
Food Review App
Game Leaderboard
Notification System
GitHub Actions

Mark as read ☒

[Next: Delivery Framework](#) →